Perks

A job for every slot of your victory row

01 What the module adds

Perks give the slots of your victory row a job of their own. Every rule of the base game still applies; this module adds one step to the recycle and a small hand of tokens beside your board.

Exactly one perk runs at a time, and you choose which at every recycle, from the perks your row is deep enough to reach *at that moment*. A deep row does not run four perks — it chooses from four. No perk runs before your first recycle.

Once armed, a perk **keeps running until your next recycle**, even if you spend the victory card that unlocked it. Spending a victory card costs you nothing now; it shows up at the next recycle, as a shorter menu.

02 Components

- **19 perk tokens** — one of each perk listed in §05. Each is a fold-over token: a **ready** face and a **spent** face. Print them from the perk token sheet, cut along the dashed lines and fold along the dotted one.

03 Setup

Do this after the base game's setup, before the first card is played.

1. Shuffle the perk tokens and **deal four to each player**. Return the rest to the box unseen.
2. Lay one token on the table just above each of **slots 1, 2, 3 and 4** of your victory row, ready face up, in any order you like. **Slot 5 stays empty**: it fills on your first research, so a perk there would be a gift.
3. You may rearrange your tokens until your first card reaches your victory row. From then on the arrangement is **permanent**.

Which slot

The victory row fills from the **right**, so the slot decides how long you wait before a perk can be armed:

SLOT	REACHABLE WHEN YOUR ROW HOLDS	THE BET
4	2 cards	Working almost at once. The safe place for the perk you want most.
3	3 cards	Reachable in most games.
2	4 cards	Late, and only if you keep researching.
1	all 5	A long shot: fill the row and never spend it down.

Every perk is equal in strength; what differs is how soon you want each one, and how much of your row you will tie up to reach it.

04 Playing with perks

At every recycle

The module adds one step to the recycle (base rules §08), after income and before you pick up your discard:

1. **Collect your income**, as in the base game.
2. **Arm a perk.** Turn all your perk tokens ready face up. Then choose **one** of the perks whose slot your row reaches right now, and turn that token sideways to show it is armed. Any perk you had armed before stops. If your row reaches none, or you would rather have none, nothing is armed.
3. **Pick up your whole discard** as your new hand, as in the base game.

Only the armed perk works. The others wait, face up, for a later recycle.

The two kinds

- **SPEND** — use it once, then turn the token face down. It turns ready face up again at your next recycle.
- **STANDING** — it simply works for as long as it is armed. These tokens never turn over.

Each token says which kind it is.

> THE PRICE OF A PERK
>
> Every victory card you spend on A, B or C is a slot your row may no longer reach at the next recycle. The more you value your perks, the fewer effects you will spend — a player who wants every slot in reach has quietly given up their war chest.

05 The perks

All nineteen tokens, in alphabetical order. A perk works only while it is armed.

PERK	KIND	EFFECT
Archaeology	SPEND	Look through the market and swap a card from your hand for one of rank 10 or under; bury yours at its bottom.
Arithmetic	STANDING	Friends of 10s: any two cards summing to 10, 20 or 30 are a legal meld.
Coercion	SPEND	Force a rival to spend a victory card on B or C now. At rank 11+, you choose which card.
Coinage	SPEND	One cashed card pays 2 gold instead of 1.
Composition	STANDING	Combination melds: play two or more melds of 2+ cards together as one.
Diplomacy	SPEND	When a rival matches your winning meld and loses, YOU choose which of their cards is set aside.
Displacement	SPEND	Move one enemy unit to a legal adjacent tile, instead of one of your own movements.
Foresight	SPEND	Look at the top card of the upgrade deck before deciding whether to research.

PERK	KIND	EFFECT
Markets	SPEND	Move one face-up card in the innovation space to a different grid position.
Navigation	STANDING	You may take the water advantage more than once a turn.
Outposts	SPEND	One card may act one tile further out than your reach.
Pioneering	SPEND	A tile you lay need touch only ONE tile already on the map, not two.
Ramparts	SPEND	A fortification survives the first time its unit is disturbed. The coin stays; the next disturbance takes it.
Roads	SPEND	One extra movement in a turn.
Salvage	SPEND	When you must set a card aside, set aside a card from your hand instead: every card of your meld still acts.
Scholarship	SPEND	One research may take a card one rank above your rank cap.
Siegecraft	SPEND	In one attack on Forest or Mountain, the ground adds nothing to the defender.
Terracing	SPEND	One of your tiles may hold one unit above its terrain limit.
Tribute	SPEND	When your meld ranks last, take 1 extra gold on top of the usual coin.

> DESIGNER'S NOTE
>
> The perks module has been played far less than the base game, and some tokens will need adjusting. The app currently includes 7 of them. Tell me which ones your table arms, and which ones it never does.